

The Next Amazon Hunt

Twenty-seven candidates across the AI stack, rated for upside and bust risk, with the IPO pipeline. Prepared for Joe Lynch, September 25, 2026. Analysis, not investment advice.

1. How to read this

You asked for the companies with the best shot at becoming the next Google or Amazon: 100x, or 1,000x over a lifetime. The arithmetic sets the field before any analysis does. Amazon was bought by the public at under \$500 million and Google at under \$25 billion; both were growing more than 50% a year at profitable or near-profitable margins. A 100x from today requires a company under \$3 billion to reach Nvidia's size, or one under \$300 million to reach the size of Netflix. Of the names pundits list as "the next Nvidia", almost none qualify, because pundits recommend what is safe to recommend, and what is safe is already large.

Base rates: over the last century roughly one US listing in a hundred delivered 100x over a 10-to-20-year hold, and most of those did it from small, unloved starting points. In a hunt like this, plan on half the positions losing money, one or two doing 5x to 10x, and the whole sleeve's return coming from not selling the one that works.

Two corrections to what I said in chat. First, the second-wave private companies (Anduril, Figure, Wayve and the rest) are not all 10x-to-30x candidates; the point is that the window one to three years after a listing, at a valuation under \$10 billion, is historically where such journeys start, and most companies that enter it still fail. Second, Cerebras is already public: it listed on Nasdaq as CBRS on May 14, 2026 at \$185 a share and trades near a \$50 billion market capitalization on Yahoo's share count (Bloomberg's fully diluted figure at the IPO was closer to \$86 billion).

Ratings. Each company gets two scores. **Upside** (1 to 5) is my estimate of the chance the stock is up 10x or more within ten years: 5 means it has the shape of a 100x and a credible path, 1 means it is already too large or too slow. **Bust risk** (1 to 5) is the chance of losing 80% or more of the position: 1 means profitable with a clean balance sheet, 5 means pre-revenue, cash-burning or single-customer. The ranking sorts by upside minus bust risk, then by upside. The "realistic multiple" is what I would actually underwrite, not the dream.

Metrics: Yahoo Finance via the yfinance library, September 25, 2026. Market cap, trailing revenue, revenue growth (latest quarter, year over year), price-to-sales, gross margin, net margin, cash and debt. Private valuations are from the funding-round reports cited in the sources.

2. The ranking

#	Ticker	Company	Layer	Mkt cap	Revenue	Growth	P/S	Gross	Net	Cash	Debt	Up	Bust	Realistic
1	CRDO	Credo Technology	AI connectivity	\$36.8B	\$1.6B	115%	23x	67%	34%	\$0.8B	\$0.0B	4	1	5x-10x
2	RKLB	Rocket Lab	Space & launch	\$47.1B	\$0.8B	62%	61x	37%	-22%	\$2.3B	\$0.1B	4	2	5x-10x
3	TEM	Tempus AI	Medical AI	\$14.8B	\$1.4B	22%	10x	64%	-18%	\$0.8B	\$1.4B	4	2	5x-10x
4	ALAB	Astera Labs	AI connectivity	\$62.5B	\$1.2B	104%	52x	75%	31%	\$1.3B	\$0.0B	3	1	3x-5x
5	KTOS	Kratos Defense	Defense autonomy	\$8.8B	\$1.5B	30%	6x	23%	2%	\$1.4B	\$0.2B	3	1	3x-5x
6	NBIS	Nebius Group	AI cloud	\$66.2B	\$1.4B	454%	49x	74%	3%	\$8.0B	\$10.2B	4	3	3x-5x
7	INOD	Innodata	AI training data	\$2.5B	\$0.3B	58%	8x	43%	15%	\$0.3B	\$0.0B	3	2	5x-10x
8	SERV	Serve Robotics	Robot fleets	\$0.4B	\$0.0B	404%	50x	0%	0%	\$0.2B	\$0.0B	5	5	0 or 100x
9	CBRS	Cerebras Systems	AI chips	\$49.0B	\$0.7B	74%	72x	35%	-75%	\$7.9B	\$1.5B	3	3	3x-5x
10	SOUN	SoundHound AI	Voice AI	\$2.7B	\$0.2B	45%	13x	42%	-67%	\$0.2B	\$0.0B	3	3	5x-10x
11	AIP	Arteris	Chip design IP	\$1.2B	\$0.1B	46%	14x	88%	-47%	\$0.1B	\$0.0B	3	3	5x-10x
12	OUST	Ouster	Robot perception	\$3.0B	\$0.2B	56%	15x	47%	-26%	\$0.3B	\$0.0B	3	3	5x-10x
13	CRWV	CoreWeave	AI cloud	\$49.7B	\$7.6B	112%	7x	67%	-25%	\$5.5B	\$51.6B	3	3	2x-3x
14	AMBA	Ambarella	Edge-vision chips	\$3.1B	\$0.4B	13%	7x	59%	-13%	\$0.3B	\$0.0B	2	2	2x-4x
15	IONQ	IonQ	Quantum computing	\$18.2B	\$0.2B	287%	74x	31%	0%	\$2.1B	\$0.1B	3	4	3x-10x
16	RCAT	Red Cat	Military drones	\$1.0B	\$0.1B	527%	15x	10%	-136%	\$0.3B	\$0.0B	3	4	5x-10x

Up = upside score (chance of 10x+ in ten years). Bust = chance of an 80%+ loss. Growth is the latest quarter year over year. Nebius's growth and Red Cat's are inflated by tiny bases; Cerebras's cash includes its IPO proceeds. Serve Robotics ranks near the bottom on score because its bust risk is as high as its upside; it is on the list because it is the only name with a true 100x shape.

Left off deliberately: Nvidia, Palantir, Arm, Sandisk and the rest of the pundit top tens, which are \$250 billion to \$5 trillion companies and cannot multiply the way you want; Hesai, Horizon and UBTech (China delisting risk you cannot hedge); Aeva and Kodiak (binary, sub-\$25 million revenue); Recursion and AbCellera (shrinking revenue); Luminar (gone from the tape, the cautionary tale for lidar).

3. The public companies, in rank order

1. Credo Technology (CRDO) upside 4 / bust 1 realistic 5x-10x

Metrics: market cap \$36.8B, revenue \$1.6B growing 115%, 23x sales, gross margin 67%, net margin 34%, cash \$0.8B, debt \$0.0B, public since 2022-01.

What it does. Makes the high-speed copper and optical links (active electrical cables, retimers, optical DSPs) that connect GPUs inside and between AI server racks. \$1.6B revenue growing 115%, 67% gross margin, 34% net margin, no debt.

Why it could be the next Amazon. Every generation of AI cluster needs more links per GPU, and Credo is the share gainer against Marvell and Broadcom in the cheapest, fastest link type. Picks and shovels with software-like margins.

What has to go right. Keeps winning the hyperscalers (Amazon, Microsoft, xAI) as they move to 1.6T links; keeps margins as volumes rise.

What kills it. A hyperscaler designs its own links, or optical replaces copper faster than Credo can follow. Customer concentration: two customers are most of revenue.

Verdict. Highest score on the list: real profits at a still-reasonable 23x sales. A 5x from \$37B is a \$185B company, which the connectivity layer can support.

2. Rocket Lab (RKLB) upside 4 / bust 2 realistic 5x-10x

Metrics: market cap \$47.1B, revenue \$0.8B growing 62%, 61x sales, gross margin 37%, net margin -22%, cash \$2.3B, debt \$0.1B, public since 2020-11.

What it does. The only public company with its own operating orbital rocket (Electron, 60+ launches) and a medium-lift rocket (Neutron) entering service, plus a satellite-components business that is half of revenue. \$770M revenue growing 62%.

Why it could be the next Amazon. SpaceX has shown launch plus satellites is a \$1T+ business. Rocket Lab is the second player in the West with the same vertical model, and the only one you can buy that is not SpaceX itself.

What has to go right. Neutron flies reliably and wins national-security launch contracts; the space-systems business keeps compounding; gross margin climbs past 40%.

What kills it. Neutron slips or fails; SpaceX prices Falcon 9 to starve competitors; 61x sales leaves no room for a bad year.

Verdict. The best "next SpaceX" story available on an exchange. Expensive, but the moat is physical and proven.

3. Tempus AI (TEM) upside 4 / bust 2 realistic 5x-10x

Metrics: market cap \$14.8B, revenue \$1.4B growing 22%, 10x sales, gross margin 64%, net margin -18%, cash \$0.8B, debt \$1.4B, public since 2024-06.

What it does. Runs AI on one of the largest libraries of clinical and genomic data in the US, sells sequencing tests to oncologists and data to pharma. \$1.4B revenue growing 22%, 64% gross margin, still losing money.

Why it could be the next Amazon. Healthcare is the largest industry in the country and the least penetrated by AI. The company that owns the de-identified patient data layer is the Palantir of hospitals, and data compounds.

What has to go right. Turns profitable in 2027 as testing volume scales; wins reimbursement for its AI diagnostics; pharma data deals grow.

What kills it. Regulation on health data; reimbursement cuts; a hyperscaler partners with a hospital chain and builds the same asset.

Verdict. A genuine platform with a moat that gets deeper every year. The slowest-growing name here and the one I would hold longest.

4. Astera Labs (ALAB) upside 3 / bust 1 realistic 3x-5x

Metrics: market cap \$62.5B, revenue \$1.2B growing 104%, 52x sales, gross margin 75%, net margin 31%, cash \$1.3B, debt \$0.0B, public since 2024-03.

What it does. Connectivity chips (PCIe/CXL retimers, smart cable modules, switch fabrics) that sit between the CPU, GPUs and memory inside every AI server. \$1.2B revenue growing 104%, 75% gross margin, 31% net margin.

Why it could be the next Amazon. Same picks-and-shovels logic as Credo, one layer deeper in the rack. Nvidia, AMD and the hyperscalers all design it in.

What has to go right. Keeps its design wins as Nvidia moves to its own in-rack interconnect; expands into optical.

What kills it. Nvidia internalizes the function; 52x sales prices in five more years of perfection.

Verdict. Excellent company, fully priced. A 3x to 5x over ten years is the realistic prize; a 10x needs a market it does not have yet.

5. Kratos Defense (KTOS) upside 3 / bust 1 realistic 3x-5x

Metrics: market cap \$8.8B, revenue \$1.5B growing 30%, 6x sales, gross margin 23%, net margin 2%, cash \$1.4B, debt \$0.2B, public since 1999-11.

What it does. Unmanned combat aircraft (Valkyrie), target drones, hypersonic test vehicles, satellite ground systems. \$1.5B revenue growing 30%, profitable, in ARKQ.

Why it could be the next Amazon. The Pentagon is shifting from a few crewed jets to thousands of cheap autonomous ones. Kratos is the only public pure-play building them today.

What has to go right. A program of record for Valkyrie or its successor; production scale; margins rising from 23%.

What kills it. Loses the collaborative-combat-aircraft competition to Anduril or General Atomics.

Verdict. Lowest bust risk on the list after Credo. Modest upside unless a big program lands.

6. Nebius Group (NBIS) upside 4 / bust 3 realistic 3x-5x

Metrics: market cap \$66.2B, revenue \$1.4B growing 454%, 49x sales, gross margin 74%, net margin 3%, cash \$8.0B, debt \$10.2B, public since 2024-10.

What it does. AI cloud built from the old Yandex engineering team, headquartered in Amsterdam. Multi-year GPU capacity contracts with Microsoft (up to \$19B) and Meta (up to \$27B); 5 gigawatts planned by 2030. Revenue \$1.4B growing 454%.

Why it could be the next Amazon. If AI compute demand keeps outrunning the hyperscalers own build-outs, a neutral AI cloud becomes the fourth hyperscaler. Nebius has the contracts to prove customers believe that.

What has to go right. Financing keeps flowing at sane rates; the Microsoft and Meta contracts renew rather than roll off; GPU depreciation stays manageable.

What kills it. \$10B of debt on a business whose assets (GPUs) lose value in three years. If AI capex pauses for two years, the debt does not.

Verdict. Big upside, real balance-sheet risk. Size it as the leveraged play it is.

7. Innodata (INOD) upside 3 / bust 2 realistic 5x-10x

Metrics: market cap \$2.5B, revenue \$0.3B growing 58%, 8x sales, gross margin 43%, net margin 15%, cash \$0.3B, debt \$0.0B, public since 1993-08.

What it does. Builds and labels training data and runs model evaluation for the big AI labs. \$320M revenue growing 58%, 15% net margin, no debt, \$2.5B market cap.

Why it could be the next Amazon. Every model generation needs more curated data and more testing. Innodata is small, profitable and growing at hyperscaler pace off a tiny base.

What has to go right. Diversifies beyond its one dominant customer; keeps winning as data work shifts from labeling to evaluation and reasoning traces.

What kills it. One customer is roughly half of revenue. Synthetic data reduces the need for human-curated data.

Verdict. The profitable small cap on the list. 10x is \$25B, which Scale AI (private) has already shown the market supports.

8. Serve Robotics (SERV) upside 5 / bust 5 realistic 0 or 100x

Metrics: market cap \$0.4B, revenue \$0.0B growing 404%, 50x sales, gross margin 0%, net margin 0%, cash \$0.2B, debt \$0.0B, public since 2024-03.

What it does. Sidewalk delivery robots operating on Uber Eats and DoorDash in several US cities, Nvidia-powered, 2,000-robot fleet target. \$10M revenue growing 404%, \$370M market cap.

Why it could be the next Amazon. Amazon won by owning the customer, the fleet and the data loop. Serve is the only public company whose entire business is a robot fleet learning from every delivery.

What has to go right. Unit economics turn positive per robot; city count and partners grow; a larger player (Uber, Nvidia) funds or buys it.

What kills it. Runs out of money before unit economics work; a competitor with deeper pockets (Nuro, Zipline, Amazon) takes the market.

Verdict. The one name with a true 100x shape and the one most likely to go to zero. 1% or nothing.

9. Cerebras Systems (CBRS) upside 3 / bust 3 realistic 3x-5x

Metrics: market cap \$49.0B, revenue \$0.7B growing 74%, 72x sales, gross margin 35%, net margin -75%, cash \$7.9B, debt \$1.5B, public since 2026-05.

What it does. Wafer-scale AI chips (a single chip the size of a dinner plate) and an inference cloud built on them. IPOed May 14, 2026 at \$185; \$680M revenue growing 74%; 35% gross margin; losing money; \$7.9B cash.

Why it could be the next Amazon. The only credible non-Nvidia, non-hyperscaler AI chip architecture that ships. If inference cost becomes the battleground, wafer-scale has a physics advantage on speed.

What has to go right. Diversifies away from G42 (its historically dominant customer); gross margin climbs toward 50%; the inference cloud wins developer share.

What kills it. Nvidia and the hyperscalers own chips; 72x sales with 35% gross margin is the most expensive combination on this list.

Verdict. Interesting technology, hard business. Wait for two clean quarters and a price under 30x sales.

10. SoundHound AI (SOUN) upside 3 / bust 3 realistic 5x-10x

Metrics: market cap \$2.7B, revenue \$0.2B growing 45%, 13x sales, gross margin 42%, net margin -67%, cash \$0.2B, debt \$0.0B, public since 2022-04.

What it does. Conversational voice AI for cars (Hyundai, Stellantis) and restaurant ordering. \$200M revenue growing 45%; losing money; \$2.7B market cap.

Why it could be the next Amazon. Voice is the interface for cars, kitchens and machines where screens do not work. The Motley Fool calls it a 10x-by-2030 candidate.

What has to go right. Reaches profitability in 2027; restaurant and automotive volumes compound; stays independent of the big-model labs.

What kills it. OpenAI, Google and Apple bundle voice for free; margins never arrive.

Verdict. A plausible 10x, a plausible zero. Position size is the whole decision.

11. Arteris (AIP) upside 3 / bust 3 realistic 5x-10x

Metrics: market cap \$1.2B, revenue \$0.1B growing 46%, 14x sales, gross margin 88%, net margin -47%, cash \$0.1B, debt \$0.0B, public since 2021-10.

What it does. Licenses network-on-chip interconnect IP that moves data inside AI and automotive chips. \$80M revenue growing 46%, 88% gross margin, up 146% this year, \$1.2B market cap.

Why it could be the next Amazon. The Arm business model (license once, collect royalties forever) applied to the part of the chip that AI makes hardest. Every custom AI chip needs it.

What has to go right. Royalty stream ramps as licensed chips ship in volume; wins Nvidia-scale customers.

What kills it. Tiny; a large customer builds its own; the stock already tripled.

Verdict. The most Shopify-shaped name on the list: small, high-margin, a toll on a growing road.

12. Ouster (OUST) upside 3 / bust 3 realistic 5x-10x

Metrics: market cap \$3.0B, revenue \$0.2B growing 56%, 15x sales, gross margin 47%, net margin -26%, cash \$0.3B, debt \$0.0B, public since 2020-10.

What it does. Digital lidar sensors for robots, trucks, industrial and security systems; absorbed Velodyne. \$200M revenue growing 56%, 47% gross margin, near breakeven.

Why it could be the next Amazon. If every robot and autonomous truck carries lidar, Ouster is the surviving US supplier. It is the eyes-for-robots pick in your own thesis.

What has to go right. Robotaxi and truck fleets standardize on lidar; software revenue grows; stays ahead of Hesai on price outside China.

What kills it. Camera-only autonomy (Tesla) wins; Chinese lidar undercuts on price.

Verdict. Reasonable entry for the perception thesis. 100x is not on the table; 5x to 10x is.

13. CoreWeave (CRWV) upside 3 / bust 3 realistic 2x-3x

Metrics: market cap \$49.7B, revenue \$7.6B growing 112%, 7x sales, gross margin 67%, net margin -25%, cash \$5.5B, debt \$51.6B, public since 2025-03.

What it does. The largest neutral GPU cloud. \$7.6B revenue growing 112%; two-thirds from Microsoft; \$52B of debt.

Why it could be the next Amazon. Same thesis as Nebius at four times the scale.

What has to go right. Refinances cheaply; diversifies from Microsoft; GPU prices hold.

What kills it. Debt. A one-year pause in AI spending is existential.

Verdict. Prefer Nebius for the same bet with less leverage relative to contracts. Not a 10x from \$50B.

14. Ambarella (AMBA) upside 2 / bust 2 realistic 2x-4x

Metrics: market cap \$3.1B, revenue \$0.4B growing 13%, 7x sales, gross margin 59%, net margin -13%, cash \$0.3B, debt \$0.0B, public since 2012-10.

What it does. Low-power vision and AI chips for cameras, drones, cars and robots. \$420M revenue growing 13%, 59% gross margin, small losses.

Why it could be the next Amazon. The brain behind the eyes for robots that cannot carry an Nvidia board.

What has to go right. Robotics and automotive design wins convert to volume; growth reaccelerates past 25%.

What kills it. Growth stays in the teens and Qualcomm/Nvidia edge chips crowd it out.

Verdict. Solid, cheap, slow. A double or triple, not a Shopify.

15. IonQ (IONQ) upside 3 / bust 4 realistic 3x-10x

Metrics: market cap \$18.2B, revenue \$0.2B growing 287%, 74x sales, gross margin 31%, net margin 0%, cash \$2.1B, debt \$0.1B, public since 2021-01.

What it does. Trapped-ion quantum computers sold to governments and cloud providers. \$250M revenue growing 287% (mostly acquisitions), \$18B market cap, 74x sales.

Why it could be the next Amazon. If quantum reaches useful scale, the first commercial vendor is the next Nvidia. IonQ is the best-funded public pure play.

What has to go right. Error-corrected machines arrive on schedule; enterprise workloads pay.

What kills it. Quantum advantage stays a decade away; the stock is priced for it arriving in three.

Verdict. A bet on a timeline, not a company. Lottery-ticket sizing only.

16. Red Cat (RCAT) upside 3 / bust 4 realistic 5x-10x

Metrics: market cap \$1.0B, revenue \$0.1B growing 527%, 15x sales, gross margin 10%, net margin -136%, cash \$0.3B, debt \$0.0B, public since 2002-01.

What it does. Small reconnaissance drones; won the US Army Short Range Reconnaissance program of record. \$70M revenue growing 527%, heavy losses, \$1B market cap.

Why it could be the next Amazon. Drones are the first autonomy that ships in tens of thousands of units, and the Army program is the on-ramp.

What has to go right. Executes the Army production ramp; wins allied and other-service orders.

What kills it. Production stumbles; Anduril or Skydio takes the next program.

Verdict. Real contract, thin margins, thin balance sheet. Speculative.

4. The IPO pipeline: what is coming, and what to do when it comes

The most important names in this hunt are not public. Amazon and Google were bought by the public within three years of listing, at under \$10 billion, and that window is what the second wave offers. The rule for using it: never buy on day one. Wait for the lock-up expiry (about 180 days) and the first two earnings reports as a public company, and buy only if the valuation is below 20x sales for hardware and fleet businesses, or below 40x for software with 70%+ gross margins. Most 2021 IPO buyers lost money because they skipped that rule.

Company	Valuation	What it is	Expected listing	Up	Bust
Anduril	\$61B (Apr 2026), \$100B talks; \$2.2B revenue 2025, \$4.3B guided 2026	Autonomous defense systems, drones, counter-drone, the Lattice software layer	No S-1 yet; 2026 or later	3	1
Wayve	\$8.6B (Feb 2026); \$1.2B to \$1.5B raised	End-to-end AI driving software licensed to automakers (Nissan first)	Management calls IPO an objective; no date	4	3
SpaceX + xAI ("Orbital Intelligence")	\$1.75T (S-1 expected)	Launch, Starlink, Starship, and the xAI model lab combined	2026	2	1
Databricks	\$190B; \$7B run rate	Data and AI platform for enterprises	2027 (CEO ruled out 2026)	2	1
Figure AI	\$39B (Sept 2025); revenue undisclosed, estimated low tens of millions	Humanoid robots (Figure 03), BMW pilot, Helix AI model	2027 to 2028 at the earliest	4	4
Skild AI	\$15B (March 2026)	General-purpose robot "brain" model licensed to robot makers	Unlikely near term	4	4
Physical Intelligence	\$11B reported	Robot foundation models (pi-0), open-source base model	No timeline	4	4
Nscale	\$14.6B	European AI data centers and GPU cloud	2026, banking phase	3	3
Nuro, Zipline, Applied Intuition, Waabi	private; \$6B to \$15B each per last rounds	Delivery robots and robotaxi tech; drone delivery; autonomy simulation software; autonomous trucks	No filings	3	3
OpenAI	\$850B to \$1T	ChatGPT, API, the consumer AI platform	Q4 2026 target	2	2
Anthropic	\$380B to \$900B	Claude models, enterprise and coding AI; \$30B+ annualized revenue on 1,400% growth per press reports	October 2026 reported	2	2

Anduril upside 3 / bust 1

Valuation and status: \$61B (Apr 2026), \$100B talks; \$2.2B revenue 2025, \$4.3B guided 2026; No S-1 yet; 2026 or later.

The defense prime of the autonomy era, doubling revenue yearly with contracts to show for it. At 28x trailing sales the IPO will be rich; but this is the highest-quality private name on the list. A 3x to 5x over ten years from a \$100B listing, and the lowest bust risk.

Wayve upside 4 / bust 3

Valuation and status: \$8.6B (Feb 2026); \$1.2B to \$1.5B raised; Management calls IPO an objective; no date.

The autonomy company that does not own cars: it sells the driver to everyone who does. Cheapest valuation of the private robotics group relative to the size of the prize. The best risk/reward of the private names for a public investor when it lists.

SpaceX + xAI ("Orbital Intelligence") upside 2 / bust 1

Valuation and status: \$1.75T (S-1 expected); 2026.

Already the next Amazon: it owns launch, the satellite internet monopoly and a frontier model lab. At \$1.75T it cannot 10x; it can compound like a mega-cap. Buy for that, not for multiples. ARK carries it in ARKQ today as SPCX; confirm the ticker at listing.

Databricks upside 2 / bust 1

Valuation and status: \$190B; \$7B run rate; 2027 (CEO ruled out 2026).

The Snowflake-plus-AI of the enterprise stack, profitable-adjacent, 40%+ growth. Low bust risk, low multiple potential. A 2x to 3x.

Figure AI upside 4 / bust 4

Valuation and status: \$39B (Sept 2025); revenue undisclosed, estimated low tens of millions; 2027 to 2028 at the earliest.

The purest bet that humanoids are the platform of the 2030s. Pre-revenue at \$39B is a four-figure sales multiple: the upside is a \$1T category, the downside is a Luminar. Only worth buying if the IPO prices near or below the last round and production has passed tens of thousands of units.

Skild AI upside 4 / bust 4

Valuation and status: \$15B (March 2026); Unlikely near term.

The Android strategy for robots: one foundation model across many bodies. If it works, it is the most valuable layer in robotics. If Nvidia GR00T or Google Gemini Robotics wins, it is worth little.

Physical Intelligence upside 4 / bust 4

Valuation and status: \$11B reported; No timeline.

Same thesis as Skild with an open-source strategy and the strongest research team. The company most likely to be acquired before it lists.

Nscale upside 3 / bust 3

Valuation and status: \$14.6B; 2026, banking phase.

A smaller Nebius. Same debt-and-capex profile, less contract cover.

Nuro, Zipline, Applied Intuition, Waabi upside 3 / bust 3

Valuation and status: private; \$6B to \$15B each per last rounds; No filings.

The second tier of fleet and tooling companies. Applied Intuition (simulation and vehicle software, profitable) is the one to watch for an early listing.

OpenAI upside 2 / bust 2

Valuation and status: \$850B to \$1T; Q4 2026 target.

The Google of the era, priced like it. Burns tens of billions a year; the moat is brand and distribution, not technology alone. A 2x to 3x over a decade is the bull case from this size.

Anthropic upside 2 / bust 2

Valuation and status: \$380B to \$900B; October 2026 reported.

Disclosure: Anthropic builds the assistant writing this paper; treat this row as conflicted and verify independently. Same shape as OpenAI: enormous growth, enormous starting valuation, a 10x is arithmetically out of reach.

5. How I would run the 10%

Eight positions at 1% of the portfolio each, from the top of the public ranking: Credo, Rocket Lab, Tempus, Innodata, Nebius, Arteris, Ouster, and one of SoundHound or Serve. Kratos and Astera Labs are the lower-risk substitutes if you want to sleep better.

Two percent held in cash for the IPO window. Wayve and Anduril are the two to wait for; Figure and Skild only if they price sanely. SpaceX, OpenAI, Anthropic and Databricks are compounders to buy for the core, not for this sleeve.

Rules. Never average down. Trim any position to 5% of the whole portfolio when it 5x's; otherwise let it run. Review once a year against the S&P; 500, and per the plan, halve the sleeve into VOO if it trails by more than 3 points a year over any rolling three years.

Expect four of the eight to lose money, two to roughly track the market, and the sleeve's whole return to come from one or two. That is what a lottery-ticket sleeve is, and it is why it is 10% and not 30%.

6. Sources

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- Yahoo Finance ([yfinance](https://finance.yahoo.com)), company metrics as of Sept 25, 2026

This paper is analysis for planning purposes and not a recommendation to buy or sell any security. The small companies here can lose most or all of their value. Anthropic, which builds the assistant that wrote this, is one of the companies discussed; that row is conflicted and should be checked independently.